



puerto rican flag



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The Puerto Rican flag features **five equal horizontal stripes (three red and two white)** and a **blue triangle on the hoist side with a single, central white star**. Its design is historically tied to the Cuban flag but with the colors inverted. [Wikipedia](#) +2



Design & Symbolism

The Puerto Rican government established the official meanings for each element of the flag in 1952: [US Flag Supply](#) +1

- **The White Star:** Represents the Commonwealth of Puerto Rico.
- **The Blue Triangle:** Symbolizes the coastal waters, the sky, and the republican government. Its three sides represent the three branches of government: legislative, executive, and judicial.
- **The Three Red Stripes:** Represent the blood that nourishes these three branches of government.
- **The Two White Stripes:** Stand for individual liberty and the rights of man that keep the government in balance. [Wikipedia](#) +2

The Shade of Blue

The shade of blue used for the triangle has varied throughout history and remains a matter of personal and political preference: [District of Puerto Rico \(.gov\)](#)

- **Light Blue (Sky Blue):** Originally adopted in 1895 by revolutionaries, this shade remains a powerful symbol of the Puerto Rican independence movement. [e](#)
- **Dark Blue:** When Puerto Rico became a U.S. commonwealth in 1952, the government officially adopted the flag but changed the triangle to a darker blue to match the United States flag. [Facebook · Encyclopaedia Britannica](#) +1
- **Medium Blue:** In 1995, the government issued a regulation on the design without specifying an exact shade, leading to the common use of a medium-to-royal blue. [Wikipedia](#)

Historical Context

Designed in 1895 by a group of Puerto Rican exiles in New York City who were advocating for independence from Spain, the flag was later outlawed under U.S. rule (most notably